MnM Party Meter

Purpose, setup, accuracy, and beta-testing guide

External OCR-based party damage meter for Monsters & Memories

WHY THIS EXISTS

MnM Party Meter was built to make damage progression easier to understand while playing with friends - from fresh-server characters with little gear through later levels, spells, weapons, and equipment.

It is not intended to shame players or turn every encounter into a competition. Damage is one piece of gameplay data, and comparisons are most useful when level, gear, encounter length, target selection, group composition, and player role are considered.

Why I made it

The main goal is to understand damage across different parts of the game, not just one perfect parse.

QUESTIONS THIS TOOL CAN HELP ANSWER

- How do classes look on a fresh server with little gear?
- How does damage change as players gain levels, spells, weapons, and items?
- What happens to party damage in early, mid, and later progression?
- How much output comes from pets, dots, procs, or burst windows?
- How does a class perform in different party positions and encounter types?

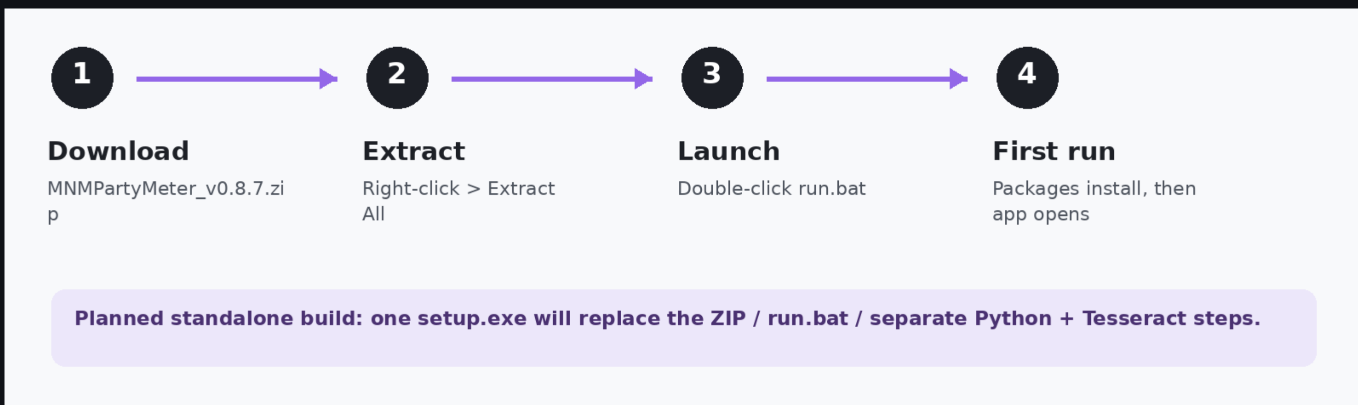
WHY EARLY-SERVER PROGRESSION MATTERS

The early part of a server tells you a lot. Everyone has less gear, fewer tools, and more uneven access to upgrades. That makes it useful for seeing how classes begin to separate - and how quickly those differences change.

A single number is never the whole story. Treat the meter as a record of a particular group, place, level range, and moment in progression.

Install the meter

The release package is designed so friends do not need to assemble the Python environment manually.



INSTALLATION

1. Extract the downloaded MnM Party Meter release ZIP.
2. Run INSTALL - START HERE.cmd.
3. Allow the installer to prepare the application environment. If a compatible Tesseract installation already exists, it can be reused.
4. Launch MnM Party Meter from the desktop shortcut.
5. Keep Monsters & Memories on the monitor containing the combat windows you plan to capture.

UPDATING

Close the meter, extract the newer release, and run the installer over the existing installation. You should not need to uninstall Python, Tesseract, or the previous meter version.

Why the meter uses two combat windows

RECOMMENDED LAYOUT

- OTHER: outgoing damage from the rest of the party.
- MY: your outgoing damage and your pet's outgoing damage.
- Keep the two windows near each other so one OCR capture rectangle can cover both.
- They do not need to be the same size or scroll at the same speed.

WHY SPLIT THEM?

A single combat window containing an entire party's damage can scroll extremely quickly. Separating your own damage from the rest of the party reduces how much text each window must carry and gives OCR more opportunities to see a line before it leaves the screen.

In a full party, Other will usually move much faster than My. That is expected. Different scroll speeds do not inherently create duplicate damage events.

The windows do not need to sit in an exact location. What matters is that both combat windows remain visible and close enough to fit inside one selected OCR region.

Designate the screen space for combat data

Use one OCR capture

The yellow OCR box begins above Other and ends below the FULL My window.

WHAT THE OCR SELECTION MUST COVER

The selected region must include the entire readable text area of BOTH panes. In the example above, you can see all four yellow edges of one single capture rectangle: top, left, right, and bottom.

Do not stop the selection at the boundary between Other and My. Other and My can scroll at different speeds; they simply need to stay close enough to fit inside one OCR region.

Configure the two combat windows

Use the same source split for Melee, Ability, and Detrimental damage.

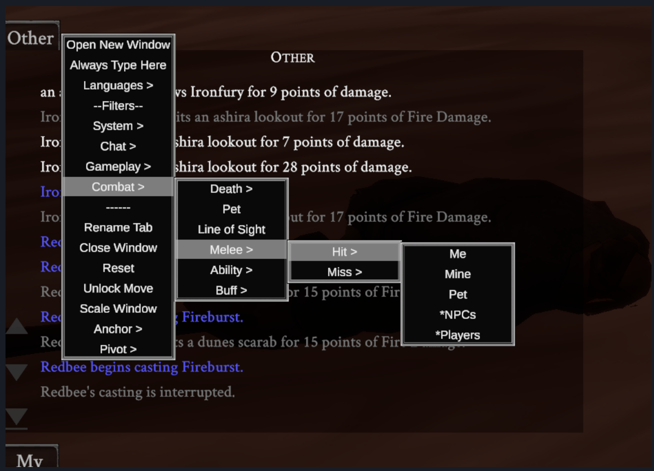
MY WINDOW

MY: Me + Mine + Pet

- Melee > Hit: select Me, Mine, and Pet.
- Repeat Me, Mine, and Pet under Ability.
- Repeat Me, Mine, and Pet under Detrimental.

Captures your melee, spells/abilities, DoTs, procs, and pet damage.

OTHER WINDOW



OTHER: NPCs + Players

- Melee > Hit: select NPCs and Players.
- Repeat NPCs and Players under Ability.
- Repeat NPCs and Players under Detrimental.

Captures the rest of the party's melee, spells/abilities, DoTs, procs, and pet-related combat text.

KEY SEPARATION RULE

My = you and your pet. Other = everyone else in the party.

- Use the same source split across Melee, Ability, and Detrimental.
- Do not mix NPCs/Players into My or Me/Mine/Pet into Other.
- The meter still uses ONE OCR rectangle around both windows.

Why this matters: spells and DoTs can be reported through different combat categories than normal melee hits. Keeping the source split consistent helps capture those events while reducing cross-window duplicate risk.

Size and place the two windows

Other can represent 1-5 other party members; both windows should remain readable and stable.

RECOMMENDED LAYOUT

SIZING TIPS

- Other and My can be approximately the same size.
- Show several readable combat lines in each pane.
- With very heavy party traffic, giving Other a little more vertical room is optional - not required.
- Keep the two windows close together so one tight OCR selection can contain both.
- Avoid tiny fonts, cramped panes, or other UI covering the combat text.

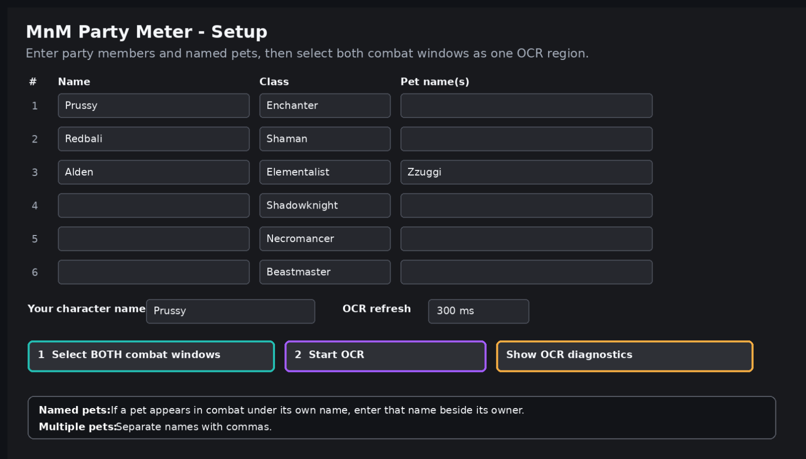
FOR THE MOST ACCURATE READS

- Keep both windows in the same place while OCR is running. If you move them, select the OCR region again.
- A quiet Other window with one additional party member is fine; the reader does not require fast scrolling.
- A busy Other window with several players/pets is also supported. Accuracy depends on the text remaining visible long enough to be captured.
- Do not make the OCR rectangle much larger than necessary. Capture the full Other + My panes, but minimize unrelated screen content.

PRACTICAL RULE

Readability first: if you can comfortably read several recent lines in both panes and both fit inside one OCR box, the windows are large enough.

Configure players, pets, and charm targets



PARTY SETUP

1. Enter party members

Add the characters you want tracked and select each class.

2. Add named pets

If a pet appears in combat under its own name, enter that exact name in the owner's Pet name(s) field. Multiple aliases can be comma-separated.

3. Charmed pets

For Enchanter or Bard charm, use an atypical target when possible: charm something your party is not also actively fighting, then enter that creature's name as the player's pet name.

4. Set your character name

The meter uses this to associate Your / You combat lines with the correct player.

CHARM TIP

If the party is fighting several creatures with the same name as the charmed pet, visible combat text may not contain enough information to distinguish the friendly charm from hostile creatures reliably.

OCR refresh, duplicates, and reset behavior

WHAT OCR IS

OCR means Optical Character Recognition. The meter repeatedly captures the selected screen region and uses Tesseract to turn the visible combat-log pixels into text that the parser can recognize.

Because the meter is reading the screen rather than receiving a structured combat log, recognition can occasionally miss or misread a line - especially when text scrolls very quickly.

300 MS DOES NOT MEAN THE SAME LINE IS COUNTED EVERY 300 MS

300 ms is the recommended starting refresh rate. The meter compares newly recognized text against recent frames and events so that a line remaining visible across multiple captures is not intended to be counted repeatedly.

RESET SAFELY - EVEN WHEN OLD TEXT IS STILL VISIBLE

Reset clears the encounter totals, timer, and duplicate/event history. The next complete OCR reading of Other + My becomes a new baseline.

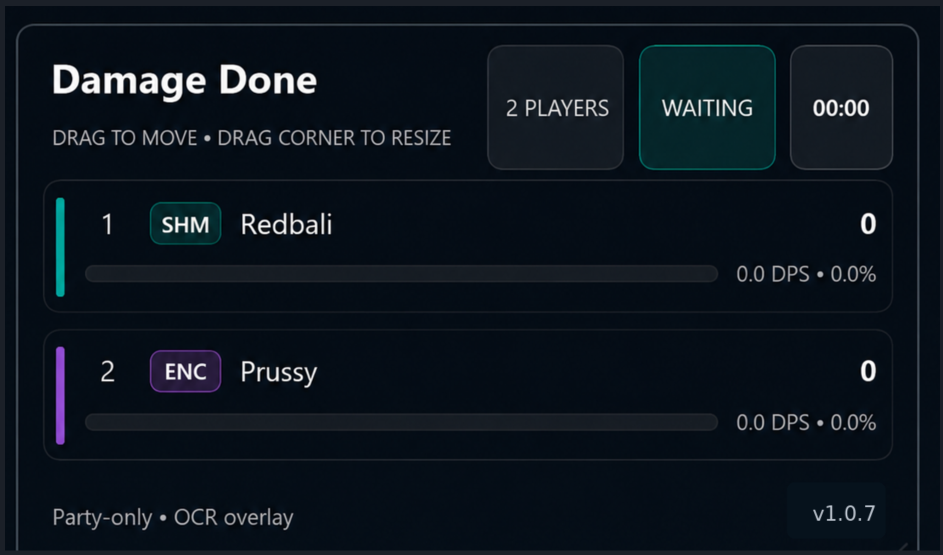
Everything already visible at that moment is treated as old combat text and ignored. Only newly appearing damage lines should contribute to the new encounter.

This means you do not need to physically clear the MnM combat windows before starting a new encounter.

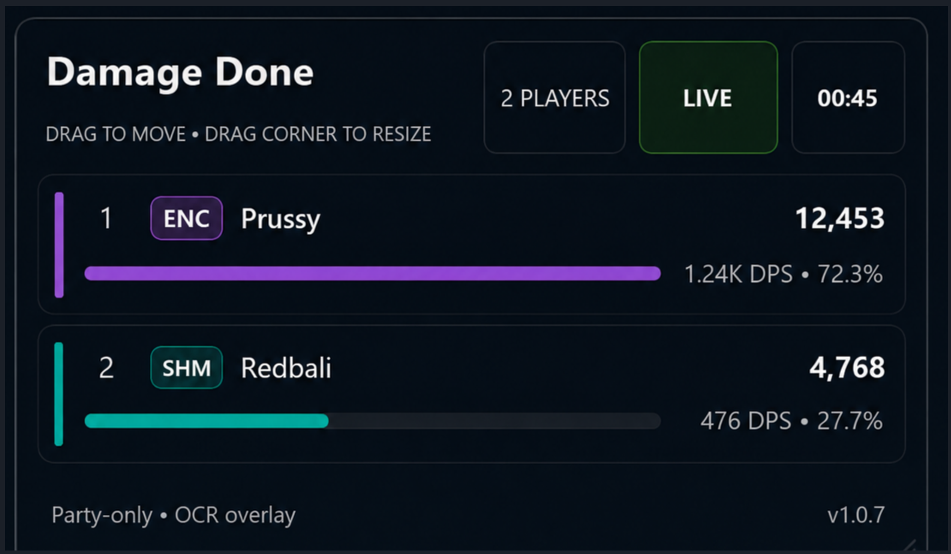
Read the overlay and use the data well

The overlay stays in WAITING while OCR is running but has not recognized damage yet.
After the first valid damage event, it changes to LIVE and the encounter timer begins.

WAITING - OCR IS RUNNING, NO DAMAGE RECOGNIZED YET



LIVE - DAMAGE HAS BEEN RECOGNIZED



OVERLAY STATUS

WAITING = OCR is active and scanning.
LIVE = at least one valid damage event was read.
Reset returns the encounter to WAITING.

WHAT THE OVERLAY SHOWS

Party ranking by total outgoing damage.
Damage, approximate DPS, and recognized share.
Class labels, player names, and encounter time.

Tip: Compare like with like - note level, zone, gear, group composition, and encounter length.

Thanks and acknowledgments

OPEN-SOURCE SOFTWARE

MnM Party Meter would not be possible without the developers and contributors who build and maintain the open-source software underneath it.

Python	https://www.python.org/
Tesseract OCR	https://github.com/tesseract-ocr/tesseract
PySide6 / Qt for Python	https://www.qt.io/qt-for-python
pytesseract	https://github.com/madmaze/pytesseract
Pillow	https://python-pillow.org/
MSS	https://github.com/BoboTiG/python-mss

COMMUNITY

Thank you to the Monsters & Memories community and to everyone who tests the meter, shares combat examples, reports problems, and helps improve recognition accuracy.

MnM Party Meter is an independent community utility. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or an official product of the Monsters & Memories development team.

MORE INFORMATION

Third-party licenses and project links are also listed in THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md in the source repository.